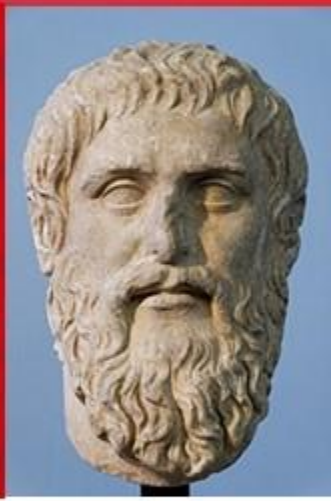
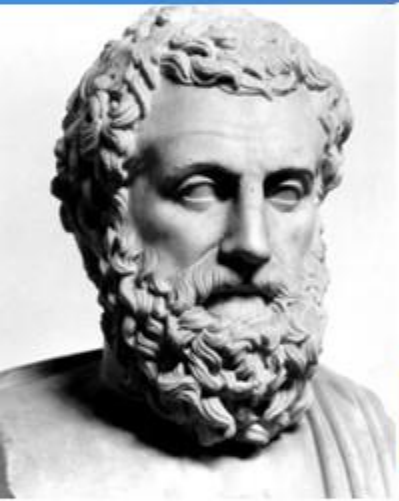


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE – 37

**QUALITY OF SERVICE
DELIVERY**

1 Quality simply means that the difference between standard and reality.

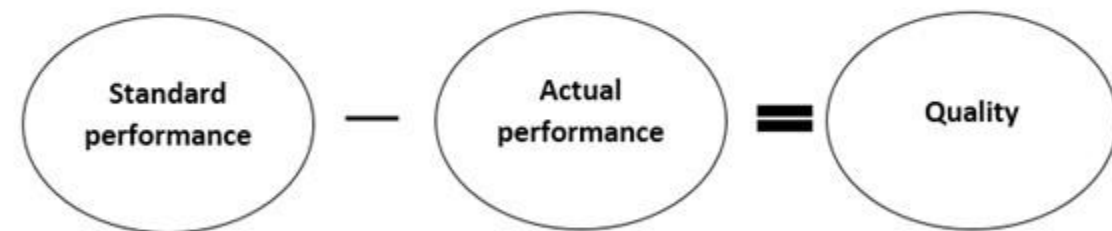
2 If the reality is close to standards, then it is called high quality and farther the reality from standards, the worse is the quality.

3 Thus, assessing quality of anything involves the following steps,

- Determining the parameters that constitute the quality.
- Setting the standard performance metric for each of these parameters.
- Measuring the actual performance of these parameters.

3 ➤ Comparing the actual performance with the standard performance to find out the variation and determine the quality. Less the variation, better the quality.

4 Applying the same test to service delivery.



QUALITY OF SERVICE DELIVERY

a

Parameters of public service

1

- of days in which a caste
is issued,
of days within which a
on of a water tap is repaired and

2

- citizen has just to apply for the
she/he should have to follow up
concerned department and so on.

3

4

-

b

1

b. Involving frontline functionary ensures probity in governance that the standard time is set realistically and practicably.

SETTING THE STANDARD PERFORMANCE FOR EACH OF THESE PARAMETERS

Setting standard number of times citizens has to personally take interest in availing public service –

a. Suppose a government may decide that a citizen can apply for a caste certificate or can register complaint of malfunction of public water tap online and then the caste certificate is automatically delivered by post or the plumber shall immediately reach to the spot and repair the public tap, then the standard number of times a citizen has to personally follow up the availing of services is ZERO.



b

SETTING THE STANDARD
PERFORMANCE FOR EACH OF
THESE PARAMETERS

3

Setting the standard number of alerts
sent to the service-seeker –

a. Suppose with regard to applying for a caste certificate, the government sets a standard that the citizen should be sent SMS when the request is made, then once when the enquiry is done and again when it is approved. Then the standard number of alerts is 'Three'.

b. Similarly, with regard to getting a water tap repaired, the government decides to send alerts once the plumber has been assigned the task along with his/her contact and again an alert once the plumber starts to the place of problem and eventually once everything is repaired with the mechanism to air the grievance if the service delivery is not satisfactory. In this case, the standard number of alerts is Three.

sms

b

**SETTING THE STANDARD
PERFORMANCE FOR EACH OF
THESE PARAMETERS**

4

Setting the standard metric to compensate the deviation from the standards –

a. Suppose a government decides that for every one-day delay in the delivery of caste certificate, Rs.20 is paid to the service-seeker after deducting the same from the salary of the employee who is responsible for delay. Then the standard is Rs.20 per every delayed day.

b. Similarly, if the government decides to pay Rs.5 for every delayed hour of repair of malfunction of water tap, then the standard is Rs.5 for every delayed hour.



C

MEASURING THE ACTUAL
PERFORMANCE OF THESE
PARAMETERS:

1 There should be a **robust mechanism** to **track** the actual performance on every service request on **every parameter**. This is made easy by **e-governance**.

- 2
- These days every service request is to be made on an **online platform**.
 - Then every stage of **service request** is noted and tracked.
 - Once the service is **delivered**, the **request on online platform** shall get closed.

3

This **mechanism** helps in measuring the performance of standard quality parameters.



d FINDING VARIATIONS BETWEEN STANDARD AND ACTUAL PERFORMANCE TO DETERMINE QUALITY:

i Time for service delivery –

- If the standard time for issue of caste certificate is 30 days, delivery of caste certificate in 25 days or less is regarded to be quality service delivery.
- If the same is delivered in 35 days, then it is of inferior quality service delivery.

ii Number of times a citizen is supposed to follow-up or visit government office

a. If the standard is that the citizen need not have to visit the government office even once for receiving a caste certificate.

b. Yet if she/he is made to visit the government office multiple times to get the certificate approved, then it is said to be inferior quality of service delivery.

c. Similarly, if the citizen receives the caste certificate by post, without having to visit the government office even once, then it is said to be of best quality service delivery.

d FINDING VARIATIONS BETWEEN STANDARD AND ACTUAL PERFORMANCE TO DETERMINE QUALITY:

iii Number of alerts to a citizen -

- If the government has **promised** to send **three alerts to a citizen** about the **status** of his/her service request and all such alerts were sent, then it is of best **quality** of service delivery.

iv Compensation for deviation from standards -

- Suppose the citizen is promised that she/he be paid **RS.5 per hour** of delayed repair of **malfunction** of a public tap and there is **delay of 6 hours**.

- Then if the citizen gets **Rs30** to his/her **bank account immediately**, then it is said to be of **best quality service delivery**.



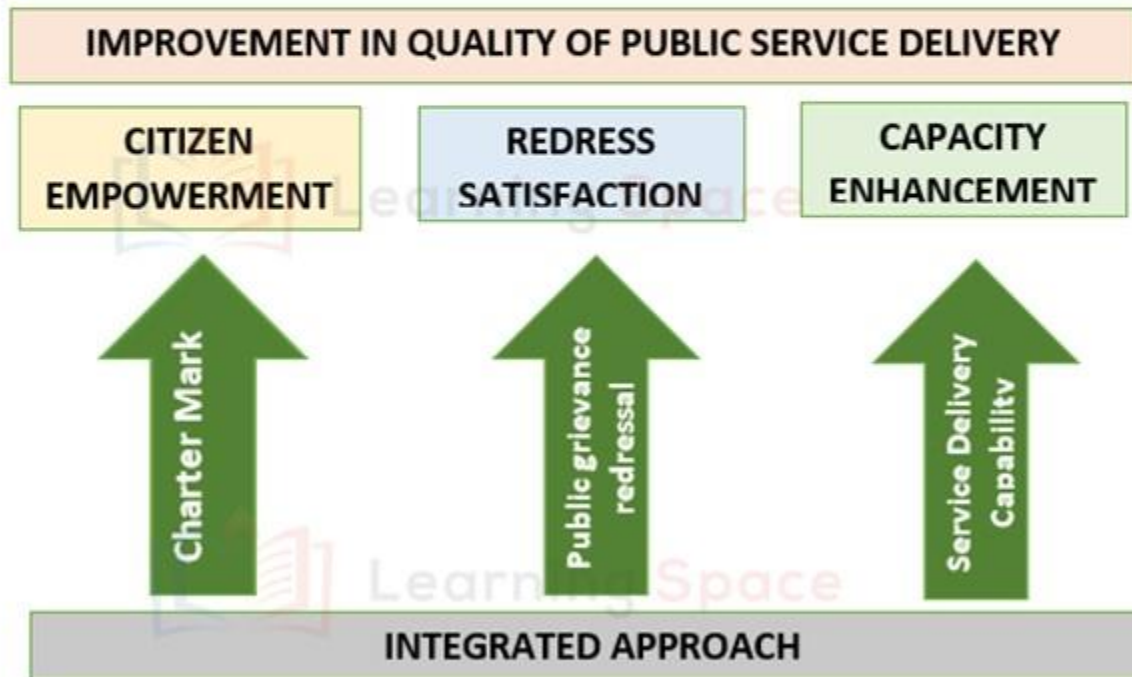
SEVOTTAM MODEL OF QUALITY PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY

This is a 3-pronged model developed by Government of India for enhancing the *quality of public service delivery*. It has three components:



सत्यमेव जयते

Government Of India



Quality as defined by user (and NOT deliverer) of the services

1

CHARTER
IMPLEMENTATION

- Involves strict display of Citizens Charters' in every government office so that citizens are better informed and they also share their inputs for the same.

2

PUBLIC GRIEVANCE REDRESS

- This component involves setting up grievance redress systems such that citizens are left better satisfied at the public service delivery.

3

CAPACITY BUILDING

- This component involves building the capacity of the employees who are involved in the public service delivery.
- Also includes installation and upgradation of infrastructure for engendering quality public service delivery.



Citizen's Charter

Public
Grievance
Systems

WHAT SHOULD A CIVIL SERVANT DO TO IMPROVE THE QUALITY OF PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY?

a AUTOMATE THE PROCESS

1 The easiest way to **improve** the quality of public service delivery is to **automate the processes** involved in service delivery as much as possible.

2 Human element may delay the things, a system or a machine would not. Breakdown of a system or technical glitches are more of an **exception** than a rule.

3 ■ A prestigious university in Uttar Pradesh made its **admission process** online.

3 ■ However, the **candidates** were asked to **personally submit the printed-copy** if their **online applications** are not found.

■ This kind of **half-hearted automation** would **worsen** the quality of public service delivery.

4 Recent government proposal is **Faceless Appeal in Income Tax**: Under the system, appeals will be randomly allotted to any officer in the country. The **identity of the officer** deciding the **appeal** will **remain unknown**.



WHAT SHOULD A CIVIL SERVANT DO TO IMPROVE THE QUALITY OF PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY?

b

REENGINEER PROCESSES

- 1** Processes involved in public service delivery often involve steps that are irrelevant and redundant.
- 2** These processes have to be identified and done away with. Otherwise, public service delivery may unnecessarily get delayed.
- 3** To illustrate, suppose issuance of a land title deed involves three scrutinises. Then the number of scrutinises may be reduced to two.



WHAT SHOULD A CIVIL SERVANT DO TO IMPROVE THE QUALITY OF PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY?

C

TRAIN THE STAFF

- 1 Observe the functioning of every employee involved in the public service delivery. And then, identify their weaknesses. Conduct trainings to upgrade their skills.
- 2 Suppose an employee may not be efficient at uploading the certificates onto an online platform, then offer him/her necessary training or assistance.
- 3 Similarly, if the employee is old and his/her eye sight is not clear and hence he/she is not able to upload the certificate online, then advise him/her to get spectacles.



WHAT SHOULD A CIVIL SERVANT DO TO IMPROVE THE QUALITY OF PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY?

d

ROBUST MONITORING MECHANISM

1 There should be **alert mechanism** to the employees or superior officers about the service requests that are about to **breach** the service standard. This has **twin** advantage:

i. The employee **responsible** for the service delivery would be **cautioned** so that she/he would deliver the **same** immediately.

- ii. The superior officers would be **cautioned** so that they would **strictly** order the **concerned employee** to deliver the same soon.
- iii. To illustrate, if the **service standard** for caste certificate is **30 days**, then the **concerned employee** and his/her superior must get an **alert after 25 days**.



WHAT SHOULD A CIVIL SERVANT DO TO IMPROVE THE QUALITY OF PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY?

e

LINKING THE COMPENSATION FOR INFERIOR QUALITY TO THE SALARY OF THE CONCERNED EMPLOYEE

1 This is a very important step.

2 If an employee delays the delivery of a caste certificate by 2 days, then a penalty of, say, Rs.25 per day may be deducted from the salary of the employee and it may be paid to the service-seeker.

3

This has twin advantages:

- i. The employee would be on high alert and would not let any request breach the standard.
- ii. The citizen would also be satisfied even if there is a delay in service delivery.



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